

1 **HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES - FLOOR VERSION**

2 STATE OF OKLAHOMA

3 2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

4 HOUSE BILL 3976

By: Caldwell (Trey) of the
House

5
6 and

7 Hall of the Senate

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10 AS INTRODUCED

11 An Act relating to hospitals; creating the Rural and
12 Small Hospital Grant Program; determining uses for
13 the funds; requiring matching funds; allowing for
14 rules to be promulgated; creating the Rural and Small
15 Hospital Grant Revolving Fund; establishing revolving
16 fund characteristics; deeming funds appropriated;
17 providing expenditure and budgeting requirements and
18 limitations; providing for codification; and
19 providing an effective date.

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22 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

23 SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
24 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 3320 of Title 63, unless there
25 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

26 There is hereby created, at the Oklahoma State Department of
27 Health, the Rural and Small Hospital Grant Program. The grant
28 program shall benefit rural or small hospitals to help with

1 infrastructure, equipment, or technology needs such hospitals may
2 have in opening a facility or to keep a facility open. Hospitals
3 applying shall have at least twenty percent (20%) matching funds
4 towards the project, and those funds may be in-kind donations. The
5 Department may promulgate rules for the grant program. The
6 Department shall use funds in the Rural and Small Hospital Grant
7 Revolving Fund created in subsection B of this act to fund the
8 program.

9 B. There is hereby created in the State Treasury a revolving
10 fund for the Oklahoma State Department of Health to be designated
11 the "Rural and Small Hospital Grant Revolving Fund". The fund shall
12 be a continuing fund, not subject to fiscal year limitations, and
13 shall consist of all monies directed for deposit to the fund by law.
14 All monies accruing to the credit of said fund are hereby
15 appropriated and may be budgeted and expended by the Department for
16 the purpose of the Rural and Small Hospital Grant Program.
17 Expenditures from said fund shall be made upon warrants issued by
18 the State Treasurer against claims filed as prescribed by law with
19 the Director of the Office of Management and Enterprise Services for
20 approval and payment.

21 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

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23 COMMITTEE REPORT BY: COMMITTEE ON APPROPRIATIONS AND BUDGET, dated
24 03/04/2026 - DO PASS.